KUSHAGRA WADHWA



GAYATRI RATHORE
Principal Secretary, Rajasthan Tourism Department

"Rajasthan has focused on the ease of doing business. In the last year, we processed 762 applications from small businesses as they'll add fresh value"

ABHAY SINGH
Secretary, Bihar Tourism Department

"The state can also play a role in scaling. Investors need land and the state can ensure that they don't get cheated"

SANDEEP NANDURI
Director, Tamil Nadu Tourism Department, and MD, Tamil Nadu Tourism Development Corporation

"The state's role in building infrastructure is very important. People are short of time, they want to immediately reach a place and experience its beauty"

SACHIN JADHAV,
Director, Odisha Tourism Department

"Earlier, investors didn't have confidence in Konark. Now we have had six proposals from 5-star hotels for the same area. The state should woo the investor, the investor will bring tourists"

AMAN NATH
Founder and Chairman, Neemrana Hotels

"The private and the public sector should drop the 'we' and 'they' line and do it together"

India is connected to a few big cities, but with physical connectivity and a growing economy, we need to push tourism down to the last mile. This will usher in the next tourism revolution," says Iyer. However, experts are conscious that such progress must be sustainable. "Tourism should not lead to conflict. If one is developing an area for wildlife, then you also need to build infrastructure for people to avoid conflict," says Meghwal.

The diversity and the uniqueness Indian tourism offers are being acknowledged not just by the world but also by Indians themselves. As Dharmendra Rathore, chairman, Rajasthan Tourism Development Corporation, says, "You might find rivers and mountains around the world, but Rajasthan is Rajasthan. When tourists who travel on our luxury Palace on Wheels train get off, they are usually so overwhelmed by how we look after guests that some have tears in their eyes." And, most times, a look of sheer wonder, too. ■